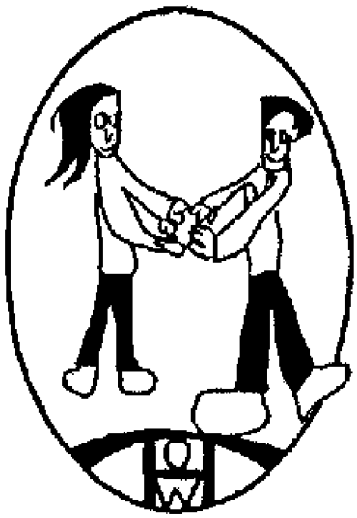
Howbridge Infant School



Science Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: May 2026

Science **May 2026**

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning

Aims/Rationale for science

All children will have practical, first hand experiences in order to promote curiosity about the scientific world. They will be competent in the skills to plan and carry out simple investigations and discuss their findings using extended, specialist, scientific vocabulary.Children will be taught the importance science has on climate change both locally and across the world. Children will be equipped with the knowledge of how science is used and the implications of science from the past, of today and for the future.

Sources used for the scheme of work

2014 National Curriculum
2018/19 Teacher assessment frameworks at the end of key stage 1
2019 Teacher assessment exemplification
Reception and KS1 Science Curriculum Map
2021 Early years foundation stage (EYFS) statutory framework

Strategies for teaching & learning

Teaching

- Within the EYFS, science learning will have a strong emphasis on developing basic enquiry skills, questioning and high quality observations as set out in the Early years foundation stage (EYFS) statutory framework, under these areas of learning: Communication and Language, Personal, Social and Emotional Development and Understanding the World.
- KS1 curriculum is skills based with a focus on scientific enquiry skills.
- Approximately 1 hour a week at KS1 and cross curricular links wherever possible.
- Science activities will be organised using a variety of grouping strategies that are most effective to deliver the learning objectives for all abilities.
- Activities and tasks are planned to ensure differentiation so that children are suitably challenged and their learning is extended. Differentiated questioning will be used throughout lessons.
- The school uses 'The Howbridge Science Squad' to teach children the key elements to scientific investigation including, aims, predictions, scientific vocabulary, fair tests, methods and conclusions.
- Key vocabulary will be discussed for each topic and pupils will be encouraged to use the technical vocabulary in all levels of communication. Those requiring the pre-teaching of vocabulary will be given this opportunity and the chance to discuss and practise using the relevant words.
- There will be frequent opportunities for pupils to make choices and take decisions both collaboratively and independently.
- Children will have opportunities to use and observe the outdoor environment throughout the year.

Learning

Pupils will be provided with a range of learning experiences. These will include first-hand experience of:

- exploratory play to gain experience of a situation or article and to develop their own ideas
- experimentation to try out ideas and find out what happens
- informal investigations to test ideas or hypotheses
- focused observation to develop the ability to notice detail and changes that take place over time
- focused practical tasks to promote understanding of a concept or skill
- sorting and classifying to group things by observable characteristics
- discussion and debate of ideas and conclusions to consolidate understanding and develop the ability to explain clearly using scientific vocabulary
- Working both collaboratively and independently

Planning, marking and feedback
Assessment, recording and reporting

- Science will be assessed in line with the school assessment policy.
- Summative assessments regularly updated and tracked on Sonar.
- Information gained from pupil records, initial assessment tasks and discussions will be used to plan activities.
- Where possible children will be encouraged to review their own progress and assess their own learning.
- A comment about learning is contained within the annual report to parents in KS1.
- All KS1 children will have a Science book containing work relating to subject knowledge and scientific enquiry. Work will be annotated with children's comments where possible to show their understanding and scientific thinking.
- Whole class discussions and some lessons in Reception and KS1 are recorded in floor books.
- Teachers plan activities that allow for challenges within the subject. All children have the opportunity to master areas within the subject at their own level. Evidence will be recorded by attaching post it notes with further details of pupils' comments and work. Challenges will be provided to extend children's learning.
- Subject leaders complete a subject review and monitor assessments. These will inform the science action plan.
- TAPs Assessments will be used regularly throughout the year to support teachers with assessing children's, 'working scientifically' skills

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupils' diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals.

More able pupils are taught within their class and challenged through differentiated questioning, exposure to higher level scientific vocabulary, group work and extra tasks. The work set for them may be taken from a higher level, involve more objectives, or require a deeper understanding.

Teachers include all pupils in Science lessons with differentiated activities that are adapted to pupils' special needs according to their provision maps/One Page Profiles. These pupils also receive individual/small group support and practice.

Teachers will always be flexible when teaching science in order to support children's well-being, mental health, behaviour and sensory needs making teaching and learning therapeutic e.g. taking learning outside, allowing learners to work on the floor.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

- Science resources are stored in topic boxes on the shelves in the Year 1 corridor as well as in class storage areas.
- The resource area is checked and reviewed regularly.
- Staff should check availability of resources prior to the start of a topic and any resource shortages should be notified to the subject leader.
- The school grounds, which include the outdoor classroom, woodland and grass areas are to be used throughout the year during science lessons.
- The Science action plan lists any equipment and resources that need to be purchased

Links with other subjects including SMSC

English, maths, history and sustainability run as a thread through the science curriculum. Children are provided with opportunities to practice and apply their scientific skills and knowledge to real life situations and other areas of learning. Technology is used within Science when it is the most efficient and effective way of meeting the lesson objectives, this includes supporting the schools climate action

plan by monitoring the schools habitats on site. Children also have the opportunity to attend Planet Protectors club each half term with the Sustainability lead to focus on biodiversity.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Procedures for monitoring teaching and learning are set out in subject management, assessment and other support policies.

- End of term assessments will track progress made, key actions and pupil outcomes.
- Reception in the moment observations will be recorded using Tapestry.

Staff and school development

Staff and school development needs are identified through School Evaluation and Development Planning and Performance Management procedures.

Relevant initiatives and reports from DFE/OFSTED may necessitate staff and school development.

Review

This policy will be reviewed annually as part of the subject development programme. It will be re-drafted periodically as necessary taking account of the school's development plan and new local and national curriculum requirements.

Natalie Pickess and Emma Ball(Science Subject Leaders)